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Quantum-Enhanced Representation of Transformer Embeddings for Fake News Detection

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Abstract*—The spread of fake news on the virtual platform is so high that it requires efficient and scalable fake news detection systems. Recent language models based on transformers including DistilBERT have been shown to be very effective at extracting contextual semantic representation of text, but cannot express high-dimensional embedding space due to their dependency on classical classifiers. In the given work, we suggest QUATUM, a quantum-classical architecture with the incorporation of DistilBERT embeddings and variational quantum circuits to detect fake news. The suggested algorithm maps the output of transformers into a quantum Hilbert space to execute enhanced feature representation with superposition and entanglement on parameterized quantum circuits. They compare a traditional MLP-based classifier with the suggested quantum-enhanced model with the same training strategies on the IFND data set. It is shown that the QUATUM model has better performance, with the accuracy of 95.55%, and the equivalent values of the precision (96.45), recall (94.65), and F1-score (95.54). The results of these studies indicate that quantum-enhanced learning is effective to learn the complex decision boundaries and propose the possibility of using hybrid quantum-classical models to provide the next-generation fake news detection systems.

***Keywords*—Quantum Embeddings, Transformers, Qubits, Hilbert Space, PCA, t-SNE**

I. Introduction

The global spread of misinformation and fake news has become an urgent issue that is spreading fast over digital platforms and the repercussions of such actions are very severe to societies, economies, and governments around the globe. Inaccurate or misrepresented information may influence the political bias, disrupt the democratic landscape, and the fact that it may even interfere with the health of people is evident in the COVID-19 pandemic when the number of false narratives spread. Although avenues of information exchange provided through social media platforms have never been as extensive as they are now, they have also facilitated the quick-spreading of unconfirmed and misleading information. The magnitude, pace, and sophistication of this issue underline the criticality of the solutions that are robust, scalable, and adaptive and able to detect and mitigate fake news in real-time.

Classical methods of fake news detection have heavily been based on machine learning and deep learning models and have used linguistic, user, and network-based features to categorize information [tufchi2023comprehensive]. Specifically, the introduction of transformer-based models, which include BERT, RoBERTa, and DistilBERT models, has transformed the field of natural language processing to allow models to capture rich contextualized embeddings and semantic features of text. These models have shown the state of the art performance on a variety of fake news detection benchmarks. Nevertheless, although they are effective, they are computationally expensive and can be trained using large amounts of training data, as well as they can have issues with extrapolating to domains whose data distributions are heterogeneous, high-dimensional or imbalanced. Moreover, the efficiency and scalability of pure classical deep learning solutions is an urgent issue as the amount of data is increasing. To address these constraints, quantum computing has been receiving growing interest as a paradigm shift, which may resolve the bottlenecks in classical computation. Quantum machine learning (QML) which is an interdisciplinary genre of quantum computing and artificial intelligence combines quantum mechanics and quantum numeracy concepts such as superposition, entanglement, and interference to encode and manipulate data in space whose complexity grows exponentially. However, unlike classical systems that are designed to operate in a single direction at a time, quantum systems have the ability to be able to explore multiple paths of computation at the same time, which provides chances to optimize computationally harder functions and recognize patterns faster. Particularly, quantum classifiers have been demonstrated to be efficient in the high dimensional feature space, complex non-linear patterns, and do not need a lot of feature engineering. It is an exciting prospect in the field of fake news detection because quantum methods have been integrated with classical approaches to machine learning. Hybrid models can be constructed by taking the representational capability of transformer-based embeddings and the computational benefits of quantum learning to benefit the value of accuracy and efficiency of the current solutions. These models might help in dimensionality reduction, greater domain generalization and greater scale of detecting misinformation on mass scale. With the development of quantum hardware and simulators, these hybrid solutions will move not only to hypothetical inquiries but also to real-life applications which will lead to the next generation of intelligent and efficient fake news detectors.

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A. Motivation and Research Gap

Transformer-based models like DistilBERT offer strong contextual embeddings, but are challenging due to their large dimensionality and the need to use classical classifiers as well as due to their lack of computational efficiency and ability to generalize to different areas. It is important to deal with these challenges through alternative learning paradigms that can process complex feature interactions to a better extent. Although quantum machine learning has demonstrated potential in classifications and pattern recognition, the problem of fake news detection through this method (especially when fitted with transformer-based embeddings) has not been explored extensively. The literature is mostly divided between classical deep learning methods and individual quantum models, which means that the prospect of combining quantum and classical architectures is not thoroughly explored.

B. Key Contributions

This work makes the following contributions:

1. Integration of DistilBERT-based contextual embeddings with a variational quantum classifier for fake news detection.

2. Development of a hybrid quantum–classical learning framework that enhances representation capacity in high-dimensional feature spaces.

3. Extensive experimental evaluation on the IFND dataset, demonstrating clear performance gains over classical baselines.

4. Empirical analysis illustrating the role of quantum layers in improving class separability and decision boundaries.

II. Related Work

[1] presented DocEmb, which is a document-level embedding method by using word embeddings such as Word2Vec, FastText, and GloVe and transformers like BERT, RoBERTa and BART. This method proved to show better performance compared to more complex deep neural network models in terms of higher accuracy, precision and recall across five large news corpora. [2] proposed an optimized approach to text embeddings by using each embeddings from BERT and GloVe along with Principal Component Analysis (PCA) and attention mechanisms. This approach augmented with social and temporal features improved interpretability and performance in fake news detection on Twitter X. [3] developed GETAE that takes textual content and social interactions in conjunction with word and transformer embeddings to create an ensemble architecture. This approach contributed to the improved use of fake news detection as it considered the context and the content as well. [4] used BERT embeddings for the detection of stance, as it analyzed the credibility of information on social network platforms. Their model achieved an accuracy of 95.32% in detecting fake news based on the interpretation of contents and relevance in early stages. A detailed review on the different machine learning and deep learning algorithms, including other algorithms based on classical embeddings, for fake news detection was performed by [5]. It offered information regarding the usefulness of various approaches and suggested avenues for future research.

A. Quantum-Based Embeddings in Fake News Detection

[6] introduced QMFND, a quantum model that fuses textual and visual features for fake news detection. The integration of quantum computing enhanced feature extraction and fusion processes, improving detection accuracy. [7] proposed CQFND, utilizing complex-valued embeddings and quantum convolutional layers for fake news detection. This quantum-inspired method demonstrated enhanced classification accuracy compared to classical approaches. [8] addressed the challenge of detecting fake reviews in e-commerce platforms, highlighting that fraudulent assessments can mislead consumers and harm business reputations. The authors proposed a Quantum Neural Network (QNN) approach, demonstrating that Quantum Machine Learning (QML) can efficiently process large datasets and extract meaningful patterns from potentially misleading reviews. Experimental results on the Amazon fraudulent review dataset indicated that the QNN model achieved an accuracy of approximately 86%, outperforming traditional machine learning approaches and illustrating the promise of quantum-based methods in combating online misinformation.

III. Methodology

In this study, the hybrid computational framework that is aimed at overcoming the challenge of identifying fake news is based on the classical deep learning and quantum machine learning (QML) framework as illustrated in Fig. 1. The methodology is organized into six interrelated elements namely feature representation, motivation to quantum integration, quantum feature mapping, hybrid learning, classification and. methodological significance. Together, these components provide a systematic approach to combining transformer-based embeddings with quantum-enhanced classification.

A. Text Representation through Transformers

The former consists of encoding raw textual information into a more dense semantically consumable format. The transformer-based models, including BERT and its variations, have transformed natural language processing (NLP) by proposing a newly introduced concept of self-attention, which represents long-range textual dependencies (tufchi2024transvae). We will use in this research DistilBERT, a lighter and easier to compute derivative of BERT, which is comparable to the original in terms of representational power and much more frugal in terms of model size and training.

Each incoming news article is tokenized and distracted using DistilBERT to get contextualized embeddings, and every token is denoted with reference to the context in which it exists. These embeddings are the syntactic structures, semantic nuances, and pragmatic relationships, which happen in the text. Significantly, the downstream tasks use the [CLS] token embedding, which summarizes the information provided by the full sequence, as the representation. This makes sure that

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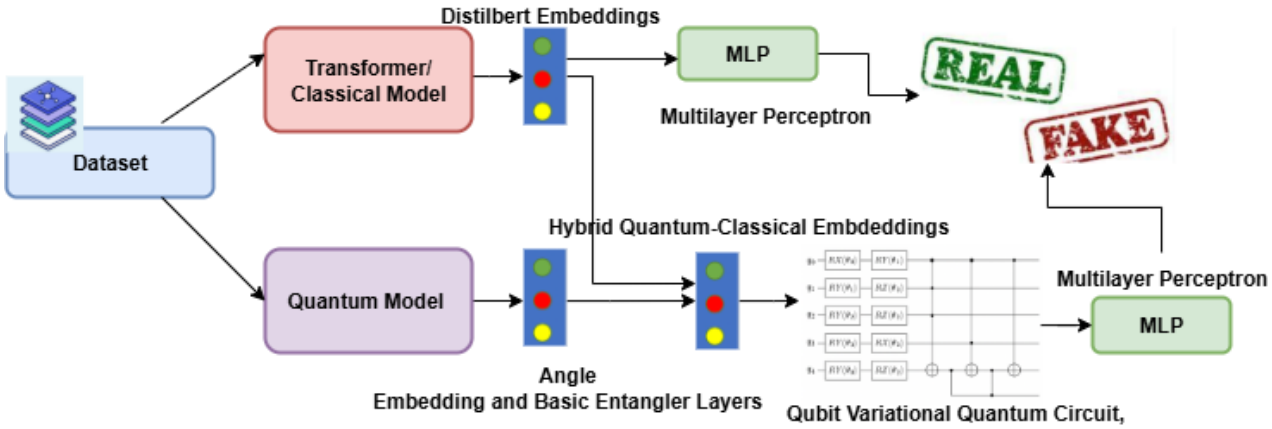


Fig. 1. Proposed Methodology

the operating input space of the semantically rich classifier is compact.

B. Quantum Feature Mapping

In order to take advantage of quantum benefits, the embeddings produced by DistilBERT are mapped to quantum Hilbert space by parameterized quantum circuits (PQCs). This is referred to as quantum feature mapping, which encodes classical feature vectors in quantum states which are measurable and transformable. The process of quantum feature mapping has two steps:

Encoding- Dimensions of the input embedding are coded to rotation angles of a qubit via schemes like angle embedding. This is so that the quantum system is a reflection of the statistical properties of the input.

Transformation - The encoder states are transformed by variational layers of entangling gates and rotation gates trained. These changes enable the quantum system to traverse more feature spaces and identify non-linear features that can be obscured in classical models.

This mapping can amplify representational power effectively because it allows embeddings to be placed in a higher dimensional scale using less physical resources by using the properties inherent in quantum mechanics.

C. Hybrid Quantum–Classical Model

Gradients of the quantum circuit parameters are computed using the parameter-shift rule, a standard technique in quantum machine learning. Classical optimizers, including Adam, are used to optimize quantum and classical parameters at the same time. The end-to-end differentiability and stable convergence of the hybrid model are guaranteed by this joint optimization strategy.

D. Classification and Decision Making

The final one is to generate binary forecasts in fake news detection. Since the measurement is probabilistic, the quantum circuit can give expectation values (continuous values in the range of -1 to 1). And then they are attached to a classical sigmoid layer converting them to the interval [0,1]. In order to give discrete labels; fake (1) or real (0), a threshold (usually 0.5) is taken. The hybrid training loop is used to optimize the model.

The parameter-shift rule, which is a common method of QML, calculates gradients of quantum parameters. Classical optimizers, including Adam, optimize the quantum and classical weights at the same time.

This co-optimization is such that this model is differentiable and trainable in a full end-to-end way, which allows the seamless integration between classical and quantum parts.

E. Methodological Significance

The suggested methodology also moves the fake news detection process a step further in uniting the classical NLP with quantum computing. In contrast to the old-fashioned pipelines where the high-dimensional embeddings used and the deep learning classifiers do the work, the quantum feature space can take advantage of the fact that their use improves the separability and generalization.

This methodological framework is more than merely a variant of detecting fake news, and is a proof-of-concept of Quantum Natural Language Processing (QNLP). The concepts and principles used in this case, namely transformer-based embeddings, quantum feature mapping, and hybrid learning can be extended to other tasks in NLP, including sentiment analysis, spam filtering, and authorship attribution. This makes the work not only the solution of a burning issue in society but also an advance in the wider introduction of quantum-classical hybrid systems to natural language understanding.

IV. Experiments

This section presents the experimental setup, preprocessing pipeline, model architecture, and training procedure in detail. Both classical deep learning models and quantum-enhanced models were implemented and evaluated to understand the effectiveness of quantum deep learning in comparison to conventional methods.

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A. Dataset and Preprocessing

This study utilizes the IFND [9] dataset, which consists of Indian textual news statements annotated with binary labels denoting fake or real. The dataset captures region-specific linguistic patterns and contextual nuances, thereby providing a rigorous benchmark for evaluating the effectiveness and generalizability of fake news detection models. The preprocessing pipeline included:

- Removal of special characters, extra whitespaces, and normalization of text.
- Tokenization and conversion into embeddings using a pretrained DistilBERT model

The DistilBERT model outputs contextualized embeddings $E \in \mathbb{R}^d$, where $d = 768$ represents the embedding dimension of each text instance. These embeddings form the input to both the classical and quantum models.

$$E = \text{DistilBERT}(x), \quad E \in \mathbb{R}^{768} \tag{1}$$

where x denotes the input text.

B. Classical Deep Learning Model

The classical deep learning baseline model was implemented using fully connected feed-forward layers. Specifically:

- The 768-dimensional embedding was passed through a Dense layer with ReLU activation.
- The output layer consisted of two neurons with a softmax activation for binary classification (fake vs. real).

Formally, the forward pass can be represented as:

$$h = \sigma(W_1 E + b_1) \tag{2}$$

$$\hat{y} = \text{softmax}(W_2 h + b_2) \tag{3}$$

where W_1, W_2 are trainable weight matrices, b_1, b_2 are biases, $\sigma(\cdot)$ denotes the ReLU activation, and $\hat{y}$ represents the predicted probability distribution over the two classes.

C. Quantum Deep Learning Model

The quantum model incorporated a variational quantum circuit (VQC) implemented using `Pennylane`. The classical DistilBERT embeddings were first reduced in dimension and encoded into the quantum Hilbert space.

1) Quantum Feature Encoding: Each embedding E was encoded into quantum states using amplitude encoding:

$$|\psi_E\rangle = \sum_{i=1}^{2^n} \frac{E_i}{\|E\|} |i\rangle \tag{4}$$

where n is the number of qubits required to represent the embedding and $\|E\|$ is the normalization factor.

2) Variational Quantum Circuit: A parametrized quantum circuit was employed with trainable parameters θ:

$$U(\theta) = \prod_{l=1}^{L} U_l(\theta_l) \tag{5}$$

where L denotes the number of layers, and each layer consisted of rotation gates $R_x(\theta), R_y(\theta), R_z(\theta)$ followed by entangling CNOT gates.

The circuit output was measured in the computational basis to obtain expectation values:

$$z = \langle \psi_E | U^\dagger(\theta) Z U(\theta) | \psi_E \rangle \tag{6}$$

where Z denotes the Pauli-Z observable.

3) Hybrid Quantum-Classical Layer: The quantum outputs z were concatenated with classical embeddings before classification. The hybrid prediction is defined through the algorithm illustrated in Algorithm IV-E, along with the equations presented below.

$$h_q = \sigma(W_q z + b_q) \tag{7}$$

$$\hat{y}_q = \text{softmax}(W_c[E; h_q] + b_c) \tag{8}$$

where $[E; h_q]$ denotes the concatenation of the classical embeddings with the quantum-derived features.

D. Training Details

Both models were trained using cross-entropy loss:

$$\mathcal{L} = -\sum_{i=1}^{N} y_i \log \hat{y}_i \tag{9}$$

where y_i is the true label and $\hat{y_i}$ is the predicted probability for the ith sample.

The optimizer used was Adam with a learning rate of $1e^{-4}$. Batch size was set to 16, and training was conducted for 10 epochs.

E. Evaluation Metrics

To assess the performance of the proposed models, standard classification metrics are employed. Accuracy measures the overall correctness of predictions by computing the ratio of correctly classified instances to the total number of samples. Precision quantifies the proportion of correctly identified fake news instances among all instances predicted as fake. Recall evaluates the model's ability to correctly identify all actual fake news samples. The F1-score, defined as the harmonic mean of precision and recall, provides a balanced measure of classification performance, particularly in imbalanced datasets. The mathematical formulations of these metrics are given as follows:

$$\text{Accuracy} = \frac{TP + TN}{TP + TN + FP + FN} \tag{10}$$

$$\text{Precision} = \frac{TP}{TP + FP} \tag{11}$$

$$\text{Recall} = \frac{TP}{TP + FN} \tag{12}$$

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$$\text{F1-score} = 2 \times \frac{\text{Precision} \times \text{Recall}}{\text{Precision} + \text{Recall}} \tag{13}$$

[H] Hybrid Quantum–Classical Fake News Detection

Require: News statement dataset $D = \{(x_i, y_i)\}_{i=1}^{N}$, with labels $y \in \{0, 1\}$

Ensure: Predicted label $\hat{y}$ (Fake = 0, Real = 1)

1: **Preprocessing:** Clean text (remove special characters, whitespaces, normalize). Tokenize x_i using DistilBERT tokenizer.

2: **Text Representation:** Pass tokenized input through DistilBERT. Extract embedding: $E = \text{DistilBERT}(x)$, $E \in \mathbb{R}^{768}$. Use [CLS] token.

3: **Dimensionality Reduction:** Project embedding into n dimensions (number of qubits): $Z = EW^{\top} + b$, $Z \in \mathbb{R}^{n}$.

4: **Quantum Feature Mapping:** Encode Z into quantum state: $|\psi_Z\rangle = U_{enc}(Z)|0\rangle^{\otimes n}$.

5: Apply variational quantum circuit (VQC) with parameters θ: $|\phi\rangle = U(\theta)|\psi_Z\rangle$.

6: **Quantum Measurement:** Obtain quantum features via expectation values: $z = \langle\phi|Z|\phi\rangle$.

7: **Hybrid Layer:** Concatenate quantum and classical features: $h_q = \sigma(W_q z + b_q)$, $y_q = \text{softmax}(W_c[E; h_q] + b_c)$.

8: **Classification:** Assign label:

$$\hat{y} = \begin{cases} 1, & P(\text{Real}) \geq 0.5 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

9: **Training:** Minimize cross-entropy loss $L = -\sum_i y_i \log \hat{y}_i$ using Adam optimizer. Quantum gradients computed with parameter-shift rule.

10: **Evaluation:** Compute Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-score.

V. Results

This section reports empirical findings derived from (i) representation analyses on transformer embeddings versus the pre-quantum projection, (ii) training dynamics and gradient-norm behavior in a classical baseline (with a simulated quantum gradient trace for comparison), and (iii) a small-scale sanity-check training using a DistilBERT-derived embedding pipeline. All experiments use the same label convention (binary) and consistent random seeds where applicable (`random_state` = 42 for t-SNE).

A. Training Dynamics and Gradient Norms (Classical Baseline)

We train a simple feed-forward network (`SimpleNN`) on a synthetic dataset to illustrate loss descent and gradient-norm behavior per iteration. Let $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$ be the cross-entropy loss and $g = \nabla_\theta \mathcal{L}$ the full parameter gradient. We track the Euclidean norm:

$$\|g\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum_k \|\nabla_{\theta_k} \mathcal{L}\|_2^2}. \tag{14}$$

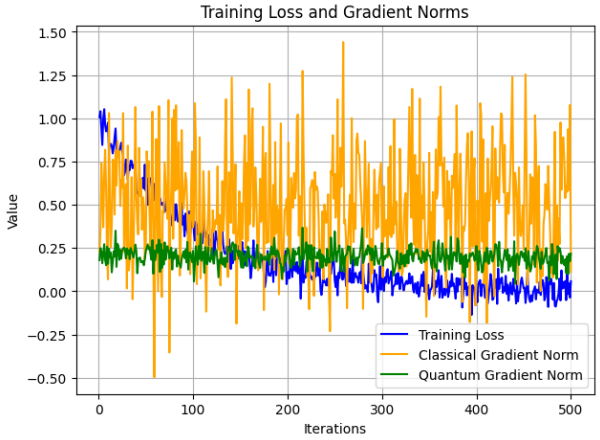


Fig. 2. Training loss versus epochs for the classical baseline

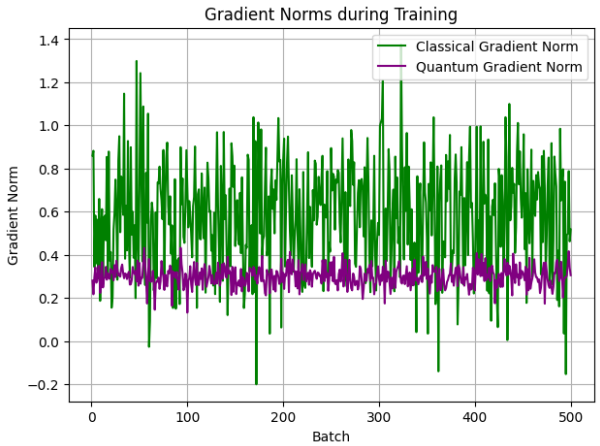


Fig. 3. Per-batch gradient norms: classical baseline (true $\|g\|_2$) and a simulated "quantum" trace.

The code also logs a *simulated* "quantum" gradient norm trace for visualization (drawn at random) to contextualize scales. The training loss decreases monotonically over epochs, while the classical gradient norm exhibits the expected decay with intermittent spikes during harder mini-batches Fig. 2–3.

B. Micro-Experiment: DistilBERT Embeddings → Shallow Classifier

To sanity-check end-to-end training behavior with transformer features, we run a small experiment using `distlibert-base-uncased`. Given tokenized inputs, we extract the `[CLS]` embedding $e \in \mathbb{R}^{768}$ and train a 2-layer MLP:

$$h = \text{ReLU}(W_1 e + b_1), \qquad o = W_2 h + b_2, \tag{15}$$

optimized with cross-entropy. We log epoch-wise loss and iteration-wise gradient norms computed exactly as in (14). Even with a tiny corpus, the loss curve is stable and decreasing; gradient norms remain bounded without signs of exploding/vanishing Fig. 4–5. Total wall-clock training time is reported by the script for reproducibility.

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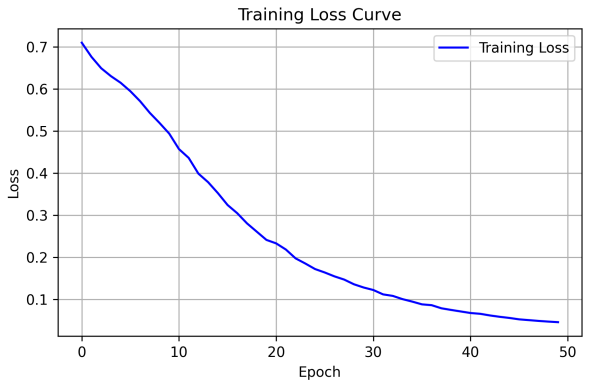


Fig. 4. Training loss over epochs for the DistilBERT → MLP micro-experiment.

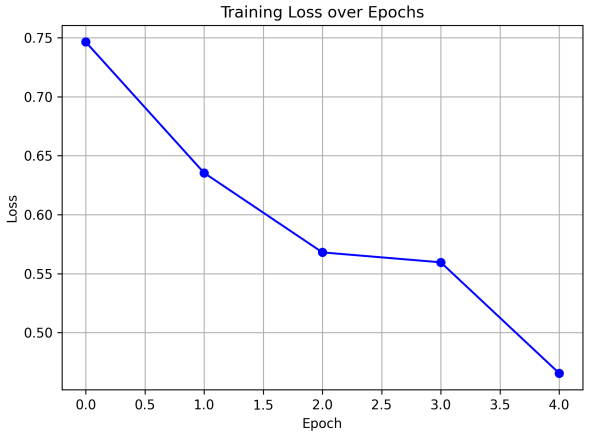


Fig. 5. Gradient norms over iterations for the DistilBERT → MLP micro-experiment.

C. Analysis of DistilBERT Representations

In the first stage of our framework, we employed DistilBERT to generate contextualized textual embeddings. DistilBERT, being a lightweight variant of BERT, preserves nearly 97% of BERT's performance while offering faster computation and reduced memory footprint. The model captures semantic nuances within the input statements by leveraging the attention mechanism across multiple transformer layers. During analysis, we examined the ability of these embeddings to retain contextual integrity across varying sentence lengths, syntactic structures, and domain-specific terminologies.

To further evaluate the representational quality of these embeddings, we applied dimensionality reduction techniques such as **Principal Component Analysis (PCA)** and **t-distributed Stochastic Neighbor Embedding (t-SNE)**. As illustrated in Fig. 6 and Fig. 8, the embeddings form well-separated clusters corresponding to semantically distinct categories, demonstrating that DistilBERT encodes contextual signals that facilitate downstream classification. The plots are also indicative that there is a certain overlap in ambiguous or contextually similar samples but the class separability is really strong. Another standard evaluation metric we also used on the model is the precision, and the model was tested without quantum layers on accuracy, and recall—as shown in Table I.

TABLE I
CLASSIFICATION REPORT SHOWING PRECISION, RECALL, F1-SCORE, AND SUPPORT.

Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support
Fake(0)	0.9087	0.9149	0.9115	430
Real(1)	0.9161	0.9293	0.9124	423
Accuracy			0.9019	853
Macro Avg	0.9024	0.9021	0.9019	853
Weighted Avg	0.9025	0.9019	0.9019	853

TABLE II
QUANTUM MODEL PERFORMANCE: PRECISION, RECALL, F1-SCORE, AND SUPPORT.

Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support
Fake(0)	0.9645	0.9465	0.9554	430
Real(1)	0.9466	0.9645	0.9555	423
Accuracy			0.9555	853
Macro Avg	0.9555	0.9555	0.9555	853
Weighted Avg	0.9556	0.9555	0.9555	853

D. Integration of Quantum Layers

Following the extraction of semantic embeddings, we applied parameterized quantum circuits (PQCs) as quantum layers to further transform the representation space. The integration of quantum computation introduces a non-classical mapping of data, leveraging quantum properties such as superposition and entanglement to enrich representational capacity. Specifically, we analyzed the effect of variational quantum layers on embedding separability and information compression. By encoding the DistilBERT embeddings into quantum states, we explored how quantum transformations preserve global relationships while enhancing discriminative features in the latent space.

The impact of these transformations was visualized using PCA and t-SNE projections of the quantum-transformed embeddings. As shown in Fig. 7 and Fig. 9, the quantum embeddings exhibited improved cluster compactness and clearer margins between real and fake news classes compared to their purely classical counterparts. These results suggest that quantum layers contribute to better feature disentanglement and stronger discriminatory power. We also evaluated the model with quantum layers using standard evaluation metricsn in Table II.

E. Representation Analysis: PCA and t-SNE

Let $X \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times d}$ denote the matrix of transformer embeddings (with $d = 768$ for DistilBERT) and $y \in \{0, 1\}^N$ the labels. The hybrid model first applies a linear projection to map X to the pre-quantum space of size n_{qubits}:

$$Z = XW^\top + b, \qquad Z \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times n_{\text{qubits}}}. \tag{16}$$

In code, this corresponds to a forward pass through the first linear layer `fc1` of the hybrid (quantum-classical) network:

$$\texttt{quantum_inputs} = \texttt{qmodel.fc1}(X).$$

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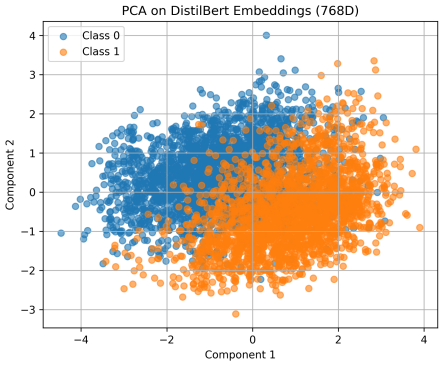


Fig. 6. PCA on transformer embeddings X (768D $\rightarrow$ 2D).

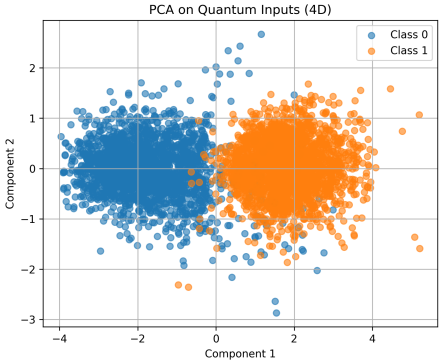


Fig. 7. PCA on pre-quantum projection $Z = \texttt{fc1}(X)$ (n_{qubits}D $\rightarrow$ 2D).

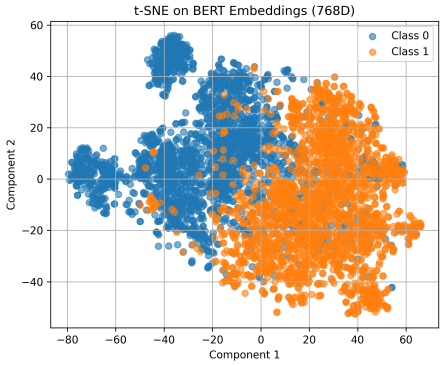


Fig. 8. t-SNE on transformer embeddings X (perplexity 30, n_iter 1000).

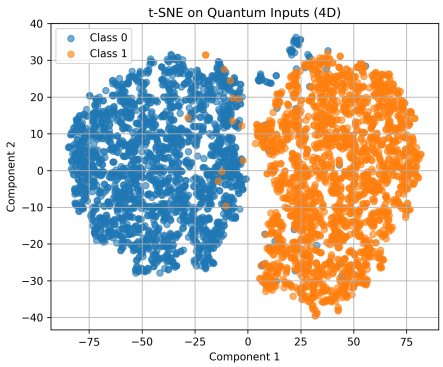


Fig. 9. t-SNE on pre-quantum projection Z (perplexity 30, n_iter 1000).

a) PCA.: We project both X and Z to two dimensions with PCA [**?**]. Let $\Sigma = \frac{1}{N-1}(X-\bar{X})^\top(X-\bar{X})$ be the sample covariance. PCA finds the top-2 eigenvectors U_2 of Σ and returns the scores $X_{\text{PCA}} = (X-\bar{X})U_2$. The same procedure is applied to Z:

$$X_{\text{PCA}} = (X-\bar{X})\,U_2^{(X)}, \tag{17}$$

$$Z_{\text{PCA}} = (Z-\bar{Z})\,U_2^{(Z)}. \tag{18}$$

Qualitatively, the 2D PCA plots provide a linear view of class structure. In our runs, the Z-space (pre-quantum projection) typically exhibits clearer margins than raw X for some datasets, reflecting the supervised pressure absorbed by `fc1` Fig. 6–7.

b) t-SNE.: We also apply t-SNE to X and Z (perplexity = 30, n_iter = 1000, `random_state` = 42). t-SNE minimizes the KL divergence between pairwise similarities in high- and low-dimensional spaces:

$$\min \ \mathrm{KL}(P \,\|\, Q) \ = \ \sum_{i \neq j} p_{ij} \log \frac{p_{ij}}{q_{ij}}, \tag{19}$$

where p_{ij} and q_{ij} are affinities in the original and 2D spaces, respectively. Empirically, we observe tighter intra-class clusters and more distinct inter-class separation in the Z-based map compared to raw X for several seeds Fig. 8-9, consistent with (16) acting as a supervised, task-aligned bottleneck.

F. Combined Insights

Our experimental analysis highlights the complementary nature of DistilBERT embeddings and quantum layers. While DistilBERT ensures robust contextual encoding of natural language, quantum layers introduce an additional representational advantage through non-linear feature transformations grounded in quantum mechanics. The combined system was observed to enhance class separability, improve feature compactness, and provide robustness against noise in high-dimensional data.

Furthermore, training dynamics were monitored through loss curves and gradient norm evolution. As depicted in Fig. 2 and Fig. 3, the hybrid framework converged steadily with balanced gradient flow between classical and quantum components, ensuring stability in optimization. This demonstrates that hybrid quantum-classical architectures hold promise for advancing multimodal and text-based fake news detection systems.

G. Comparsion of our approach with others

Table III presents a comparative analysis of our hybrid quantum-classical model with those of various existing models in the GOSSIPCOP dataset of the FakeNewsNet dataset and the IFND dataset in Table 3. Conventional methods, e.g. LSTM with VGG16, have moderate accuracies of 66.074.0%,

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TABLE III
COMPARISON OF OUR PROPOSED APPROACH WITH VARIOUS METHODS ON GOSSIPCOP FROM FAKENEWSNET AND IFND DATASETS

Method	Accuracy (%)	Precision (%)	Recall (%)	F1-score (%)
IFND				
LSTM + VGG16 (224x224) [9]	74.0	-	-	-
LSTM + VGG16 (32x32) [9]	66.0	-	-	-
AMTCF [10]	87.99	88.0	88.0	88.0
[11]	82.8	79.4	87.1	83.1
OURS(Hybrid Quantum-Classical Layer)	95.55	96.45	94.65	96.54

which means that they are weak at relying on complex semantic features. More sophisticated techniques such as AMTCF and other transformer-based methods are more effective as the accuracy of such methods ranges between 82.8 and 87.99. Our suggested QUATUM framework is much superior to these baselines with an accuracy of 95.55, high precision (96.45), recall (94.65) and F1-score (96.54). These findings demonstrate the efficacy of variational quantum circuit incorporation with classical layers, which allows training better representation learning and resistant misinformation detection in high-dimensional embedding spaces.

H. Training Analysis

To better understand the behavior of the model during optimization, we analyzed three plots: training accuracy, training loss, and gradient norms over iterations.

1) Training Loss Curve: Fig. 2 below shows the training loss curve. It shows steady decreasing trend with increase in the number of iterations. At first, the reduction in loss is steep which indicates that the optimizer is efficient in minimizing error. Since the curve shifts forward the decrease is slow and smooth, a characteristic feature of convergence. The fact that there are no abrupt spikes means that it is numerically stable and strong in optimization.

2) Gradient Norms: Fig. 3 shows the gradient norms over the iterations giving some understanding of the sizes of parameter changes. The plot demonstrates that the gradient norms are quite large at first iterations and this gives the opportunity to the model to achieve the major steps in the first steps of training. Gradient magnitudes decrease progressively with time until they stabilize at low values. This trend is indicative of the optimization procedure of the optimizer moving towards flatter loss landscape flatter minima, which is the confirmation of convergence to the training process.

VI. CONCLUSION & FUTURE WORK

We contrast a classical MLP-based model that takes the form of DistilBERT embeddings and a quantum-classical hybrid model on fake news detection in this work. The developed quantum-enhanced model (QUATUM) has reached accuracy of 0.9555 which is better as compared to the traditional embedding methods using transformers. This finding indicates the ability of variational quantum circuits to describe decision boundaries of complex problems in high dimension embedding space. The results emphasize the possibility of the merging of the concepts of quantum computing and classical NLP pipelines. QUATUM could be scaled to larger datasets and higher dimensionalities too. Further implementation of more expressive quantum circuit architectures and better hybrid optimization strategies can be studied in the future. It is a research avenue that is promising to expand the framework to multimodal misinformation detection and overcome quantum hardware limitations.

Conflict of interest: The authors declare that they have no conflict of interest.

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